

ENG517 SHORT HANDOUTS

MIDTERM

Lesson 01 to 05

(ENG517) Computer Assisted Language Learning

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Lecture- 01

Introduction to CALL

Topic 01-02: Introduction to CALL

What does CALL stand for, and how is it defined?

CALL stands for Computer-Assisted Language Learning. It's defined as "the search for and study of applications of the computer in language teaching and learning" (Levy, 1997).

What are some recent developments that make CALL important?

Recent developments in technology and communication provide new opportunities for language learning, making CALL increasingly essential.

How do multimedia programs and the internet contribute to CALL?

Multimedia programs offer audio, graphics, and video, while the internet provides access to authentic texts and real-time intercultural communication.

What challenges come with the availability of technology in language learning?

Implementing technology in the language classroom is a challenge despite its availability.

Topic 01-03: Aim of CALL

What is the main aim of CALL?

The main aim of CALL is to use computers for teaching and learning a language, incorporating various technologies and applications.

What are some other terms associated with CALL?

CALL is also known as Computer-Aided Language Learning (CALL), Computer-Assisted Language Instruction (CALI), and Computer-Enhanced Language Learning (CELL).

Topic 01-04: Importance of CALL

What are some reasons why ELT teachers use CALL?

ELT teachers use CALL because computers can assist both teachers and learners, offer multimedia applications, and provide flexibility in class scheduling and individual learning.

How does the computer contribute to communicative language teaching?

The computer provides a meaning-focused, communicative learning environment that aligns with communicative language teaching.

Topic 01-05: Perceptions about CALL

Is CALL considered a language teaching method, and what approach is it based on?

CALL is not considered a language teaching method. In traditional CALL, it was based on a behavioristic approach, but modern CALL emphasizes communication and tasks.

How does the role of the computer in CALL change over time?

The role of the computer in CALL has shifted from input-control-feedback to managing communication, text, audio, and video.

Topic 01-07: Available Literature on CALL

How has the field of CALL evolved in terms of technology usage?

CALL has evolved with advances in technology, including the integration of various devices, networks, and peripheral technologies.

What are some aspects of CALL that research focuses on?

CALL research covers various aspects, from demonstrating the effectiveness of computers in language teaching to evaluating software and tasks.

Topic 03-05: The Scope of CALL

What criticism has CALL faced historically?

CALL has faced criticism for being "technology-driven" at the expense of theory, research, and pedagogy.

What frameworks have been proposed to guide CALL in a more coherent direction?

Various conceptualizations or frameworks have been proposed to guide CALL, such as those by Bax, Chapelle, and others.

What are some influential views about integrating technology into language teaching?

Chapelle views CALL as aligning with principles from interactionist perspectives of second language acquisition, while Bax emphasizes the normalization of technology in language teaching.

Does CALL have a discrete theory of its own, or does it rely on other theories?

CALL mainly relies on theories developed for other purposes, and it doesn't necessarily need a discrete theory of its own.

What potential does CALL have for English language teaching?

CALL can interest and motivate learners, offer flexibility, and improve information access when used with clear educational objectives.

What role does CALL play in language learner control?

CALL allows learners to control their own learning process and provides well-designed software for meaningful language learning environments.

How did CALL emerge as a distinct field, and what were some early initiatives?

CALL emerged with the spread of personal computers in the 1980s. Early initiatives included projects like the PLATO system and academic work with microcomputers.

How has research influenced the development of CALL?

Research has played a significant role in shaping CALL, moving it toward more promising directions and establishing its credibility in applied linguistics and education.

Lecture- 02

The Brief History of CALL- I

Topic 06: CALL in the 1950s and 1960s

What was the initial phase of CALL in the 1950s and 1960s referred to as?

Behavioristic CALL

What was the primary instructional approach used in this phase of CALL?

Behaviorist theories of learning, involving repetitive language drills (drill and practice).

Why was the computer considered ideal for conducting repeated drills in language learning?

Computers can provide immediate non-judgmental feedback, present material on an individualized basis, and allow students to learn at their own pace.

What were the challenges associated with early computers used for language learning in the 1950s and 1960s?

Early computers were large mainframes, located on university campuses, and lacked processing power. Students had to travel to access them, and costs were high.

What were the motivations behind funding language research and CALL programs in the 1950s and 1960s?

Funding for language research, particularly for military purposes, **was motivated by Cold War concerns, such as the USSR's advances in science after the launch of Sputnik in 1957.**

Name three pioneering institutions that created the first CALL programs.

Stanford University, Dartmouth University, and the University of Essex (The Scientific Language Project).

Topic 07: CALL in the 1970s

What was the focus of the second phase of CALL in the 1970s?

The communicative approach to teaching.

What is the key idea behind communicative language teaching (CLT)?

CLT emphasizes interaction as both the means and the ultimate goal of language study.

Who was one of the main advocates of the communicative approach in CALL?

John Underwood.

List three key characteristics of communicative CALL according to John Underwood.

Focus on using forms rather than the forms themselves, teaching grammar implicitly, and creating an environment where using the target language feels natural.

What was introduced in 1975 that spurred the development of small applications on computers?

Answer: Microcomputers were first sold in kit form.

What was the processing capacity of the Timex-Sinclair microcomputer?

The Timex-Sinclair had a processing capacity of 16K.

What technology was a focus of CALL research during the 1970s and 1980s, featuring rapid access to multiple points on a disk?

Videodisc technology.

Why did Compact Disk Read-Only Memory (CD-ROMs) replace videodiscs?

CD-ROMs had a greater installed base in personal computers, a smaller and more convenient format, and were less prone to warping.

What advantages did videodisc technology offer for language learning according to Bush and Crotty?

Advantages included a priority of listening over speaking, modeling, and creating a low-anxiety atmosphere for learners.

Topic 08: CALL in the 1980s

What were the two important factors that undermined CALL in the late 1970s and early 1980s?

Rejecting drilling and rote learning approaches, and the introduction of microcomputers.

Who made an assessment of CALL methodologies in 1988, and what were the main points of that assessment?

Pederson. The main points included meaningful practice, development of language, documenting student differences and difficulties, the impact of differences on strategies, more positive student attitude when the CALL is made by their teacher, securing computer resources, and teacher dissatisfaction with software.

How were language teachers involved in the development and use of CALL materials in the 1980s?

Language teachers not only played a role in developing CALL material but also used them effectively with students.

What applications were developed for language teaching in the 1980s?

Applications included Macario, Montevideo, Interactive Dígame, and ALLP.

What was Macario, and how was it adapted for language learning?

Macario was an early videodisc program for learning Spanish. It was adapted from a feature-length commercial video into an interactive format to teach listening skills.

Topic 09: CALL in the 1990s

How did CALL change in the 1990s in terms of its purpose and use?

CALL shifted from drill and tutorial purposes to extending education beyond

the classroom and reorganizing instruction.

What significant technology was introduced in the 1990s that opened up new possibilities in CALL?

The World Wide Web was launched, reaching the general public by 1993, which opened up new possibilities in CALL.

What technological developments characterized CALL in the 1990s, and how did they impact language learning?

Multimedia technology, computer-mediated communication, and the Internet influenced CALL, providing text, graphics, sound, and animation, and extending language learning beyond the classroom.

Topic 10: CALL in the 21st century

What technological advances have played a role in CALL in the 21st century?

Integration of computing facilities, mobile telephones, online downloading facilities, USB, television, and programs like Earworms.

How has the role of teachers changed in the 21st century regarding CALL, and what approaches have been emphasized?

Teachers have emphasized integrating language skills (listening, speaking, reading, and writing) and technology more fully into the language learning process, moving toward social and socio-cognitive views of language teaching.

What technological developments, such as Multimedia CALL and Web-based CALL, have shaped CALL in the 21st century?

Multimedia CALL and Web-based CALL have integrated multimedia technology and authentic materials from the World Wide Web into language learning.

How has the Internet and technology transformed the availability of authentic materials in language learning in the 21st century?

The Internet provides a global database of authentic materials that enhance language learning and teaching.

Lecture- 03

Models for CALL

Topic 11: Defining a Model of CALL

What does Dunkin and Biddle's model of CALL address?

Dunkin and Biddle's model addresses the role of computer and multimedia in language learning, specifically Computer-Assisted Language Learning (CALL).

What is the principal concern of this lesson?

The principal concerns are related to traditional models of the educational process, differences between CALL and traditional learning, and how CALL can be portrayed in a model.

Topic 12: Dunkin and Biddle's Model in a CALL Context

Can CALL completely replace a human teacher in language learning?

A3: No, there is no empirical evidence to suggest that CALL alone can replace a human teacher in language learning.

What is the concept of "Locus of Control" in CALL?

"Locus of Control" refers to the degree of responsibility for learning decisions, with one end being more learner-controlled (constructivist) and the other more program-controlled (behaviorist).

What is the role of a virtual classroom in CALL?

A virtual classroom in CALL allows learners to communicate, view presentations, interact with resources, and collaborate online, expanding beyond the traditional classroom.

Topic 13: Teacher and Pupil Classroom Behavior in CALL

How do computers enhance learner autonomy in CALL?

Computers enhance learner autonomy in CALL by providing learning opportunities beyond the constraints of time and place, allowing learners to revisit and extend their learning at any time or location with an internet connection.

How are CALL activities categorized in terms of taxonomies?

CALL activities can be categorized based on the focus of the software (e.g., grammar, vocabulary, fluency), targeted language skills (e.g., reading, writing, speaking, listening), or Bloom's levels of questions and learner characteristics (e.g., age, gender, skill level).

Topic 14: Aspects of a CALL Model

How is a CALL model different from traditional classroom teaching models?

A CALL model differs from traditional models by accommodating the unique aspects of technology, learner control, and learning resources available in a computer-assisted language learning environment.

What is meant by "Locus of Control" in CALL and how does it affect learning?

"Locus of Control" in CALL refers to the degree of control learners have over their learning process, and it can range from more program-controlled (behaviorist) to more learner-controlled (constructivist), affecting the learning experience.

Topic 15: CALL Material Problems

What were some initial problems with CALL materials?

Initial problems with CALL materials included a lack of funds, expertise, and suitable authoring tools for creating materials.

Can a single practical model encompass all aspects of CALL effectively?

It's unlikely that a single practical model can encompass all aspects of CALL effectively due to the diverse approaches to teaching and learning languages through technology.

Lecture- 04

CALL Applications

Topic No: 16 - CALL Applications - I

What are the eight generic CALL applications discussed in this lesson?

The eight generic CALL applications are:

1. Word processing
2. Games
3. Literature
4. Corpus linguistics
5. Computer-mediated communication (CMC)
6. WWW resources
7. Adapting other materials for CALL
8. Personal Digital Assistants (PDAs) and mobile telephones

Why do learners increasingly use computer-based spelling checkers?

Learners increasingly use computer-based spelling checkers because they provide a convenient way to correct spelling errors in the composition process.

What challenges exist in using word processing programs for language learning?

Word processing programs are often designed for business environments, and they may not provide feedback or record misspellings. Learners may choose corrections without considering their appropriateness, and spelling checker programs can allow learners to add misspelled words to dictionaries.

Topic No: 17 - Language Games and Literature

What is the advantage of using literature in language learning?

Literature offers valuable authentic material, cultural enrichment, language enrichment, and personal involvement in language learning. It exposes learners to various linguistic uses, forms, and conventions.

What is Data Driven Learning (DDL)?

Data Driven Learning (DDL) is an approach where learners use concordancing programs and corpora to investigate grammatical structures, idioms, and general language usage. They become their own researchers and develop rules for language learning.

Topic No: 18 - Computer-mediated Communication

What does CMC stand for, and what are some examples of CMC?

CMC stands for Computer-Mediated Communication. Examples of CMC include email, bulletin boards, chat lines, MOO (Multi-User Domains, Object Oriented) environments, and social networking services like Facebook and Twitter.

How can email enhance learning in language education?

Email allows learners to communicate with peers, teachers, and native speakers, sharing information, assignments, questions, and thoughts. It provides a record of messages and is a flexible means of communication.

What are some challenges in establishing email pen pals (net pals)?

Challenges in establishing email pen pals include difficulty in communication due to errors, slang, idioms, and typos, as well as issues with effective exchange and comprehension.

Topic No: 19 - WWW Resources and Adapting Materials

How can the World Wide Web (WWW) be used in language learning?

The WWW offers opportunities for language learning through commercial websites, educational websites, and resources created by learners and teachers. It provides authentic text, images, sound, and video.

What are virtual treasure hunts, and how can they be used in language learning?

Virtual treasure hunts involve assigning learners to collect images or explanations on various topics from the WWW. They expose learners to the target language in the course of the hunt.

Topic No: 20 - Personal Digital Assistants (PDAs) and Mobile Telephones

What is the main challenge in using PDAs for language learning?

A significant challenge is the recognition of handwriting on PDAs. Early models imposed certain restrictions on how users should write to be recognized by the device.

What is Graffiti Handwriting Software, and what was its purpose?

Graffiti Handwriting Software was used on PDAs for recognizing handwriting. Users had to adapt their handwriting to Graffiti, which simplified punctuation, numbers, and upper-case letters. The purpose was to enable easy recognition of characters on PDAs.

What are some future considerations for PDAs and mobile phones in language learning?

The success of PDAs and mobile phones in language learning depends on accommodating reliable voice recognition and remaining cost-effective compared to laptop computers.

Lecture- 5

CALL and SLA

Topic 21: Second-Language Acquisition (SLA); Comprehensible input and output

What is the principal concern of the lesson in Topic 21?

Defining the meanings of and relevance to CALL in related terms.

What does SLA stand for?

Answer: Second-Language Acquisition

Describe the concept of "Negotiation of Meaning."

Answer: It's the interactional work done by speakers and listeners to ensure a common understanding of the ongoing meanings of discourse.

How can a computer program assist in SLA through negotiation of meaning?

By providing comprehensible input and promoting collaboration between learners and the computer.

What is one challenge with computer programs for SLA related to errors?

It's challenging for a computer to decide when to tolerate errors and when to correct them.

Topic 22: T. Pica on theory in SLA

Why is the field of second-language acquisition considered both theory-less and theory-laden?

It's considered theory-less because there's no single coherent theory to describe second-language learning, and it's theory-laden due to the presence of various claims, arguments, theories, and perspectives.

Topic 23: Mastery learning; Constructivism; Schema Theory

What is mastery learning based on?

It's based on the assumption that learning is a function of time, and nearly all students can learn a subject to the point of mastery with varying time for learning.

How does constructivism differ from behaviorism in terms of learning?

Constructivism suggests that learning is a process in which learners construct new ideas using their own knowledge and experiences, while behaviorism implies that learning involves breaking down knowledge into instructional steps and rules.

What is schema theory, as defined by Nunan?

Schema theory is "a theory of language processing which suggests that discourse is interpreted with reference to the background knowledge of the reader or listener."

How do experts and novices differ in handling new information, according to T.G. Anderson?

Experts break down new information into more relevant chunks, have more developed schemata, and can efficiently connect new information to their existing knowledge.

Topic No: 24 - Behaviorism

What is a defining characteristic of many CALL materials?

Heavy reliance on behaviorist methods of instruction.

What are some principles of behaviorism commonly used in CALL materials?

Strictly sequenced lessons, motivation through incentives, and grading based on standardized tests.

Who is often associated with behaviorism in the classroom?

B. F. Skinner.

What does Skinner's theory of behaviorism emphasize?

Rote learning, mimicry, memorization, and rewards for positive responses.

Topic No: 25 - Programmed Instruction, Constructivism, and Collaboration

What is programmed instruction in behaviorist models?

Teaching subjects in small steps, with each step requiring appropriate responses from learners.

Who is credited with the idea of an "automated book"?

Sidney L. Pressey.

How does constructivism differ from behaviorism in terms of learners?

Constructivism assumes that learners come with a rich set of ideas and experiences.

What role does collaboration play in the constructivist model?

Collaboration encourages negotiation of meaning and helps learners build new schemata and extend existing ones.

Can collaboration and negotiation of meaning exist in both behaviorist and constructivist models?

Yes, they may exist in both models, but their effectiveness within each model needs to be examined.

Working on the Next Lessons

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